



glossy blue body

30 cm
12 in**SPLENDID GLOSSY STARLING***Lamprotornis splendidus*

Widespread in sub-Saharan Africa, this species belongs to a group of African starlings characterized by a metallic sheen on their plumage.

22 cm
9 in**EUROPEAN STARLING***Sturnus vulgaris*

Native to Eurasia, but introduced to N. America, this common starling roosts communally, in groups that gather after mass aerial manoeuvres.

18 cm
7 in**HILDEBRANDT'S STARLING***Lamprotornis hildebrandti*

This E. African glossy starling occurs in wooded savanna, where it preys on large ground insects, often flocking with other starling species.

18–19 cm
7–7½ in**EMERALD STARLING***Lamprotornis iris*

This glossy W. African species feeds mainly on fruits, especially figs, but also takes ants.



red or white spot on blue throat

BLUETHROAT*Luscinia svecica*

A relative of the nightingale, the bluethroat breeds in damp regions of N. Eurasia, and migrates to Africa and S.E. Asia.

18 cm
7 in**WHITE-TAILED ROBIN***Myiomela leucura*

A bird of riverine forests from the Himalayas to Indochina, it usually keeps close to the ground unless disturbed.

13 cm
5 in**PIED FLYCATCHER***Ficedula hypoleuca*

This large genus of mainly Asian flycatchers is closely related to chats. This woodland species ranges from Europe to Siberia.

17 cm
6½ in**COMMON NIGHTINGALE***Luscinia megarhynchos*

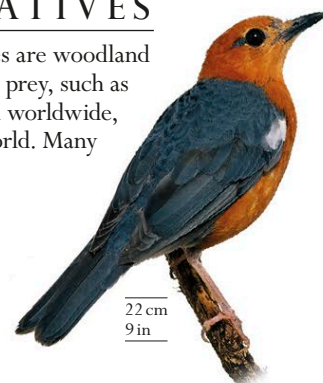
This brown bird of W. to C. Eurasian thickets is known for its loud, rich song, which it sings night or day.

THRUSHES AND RELATIVES

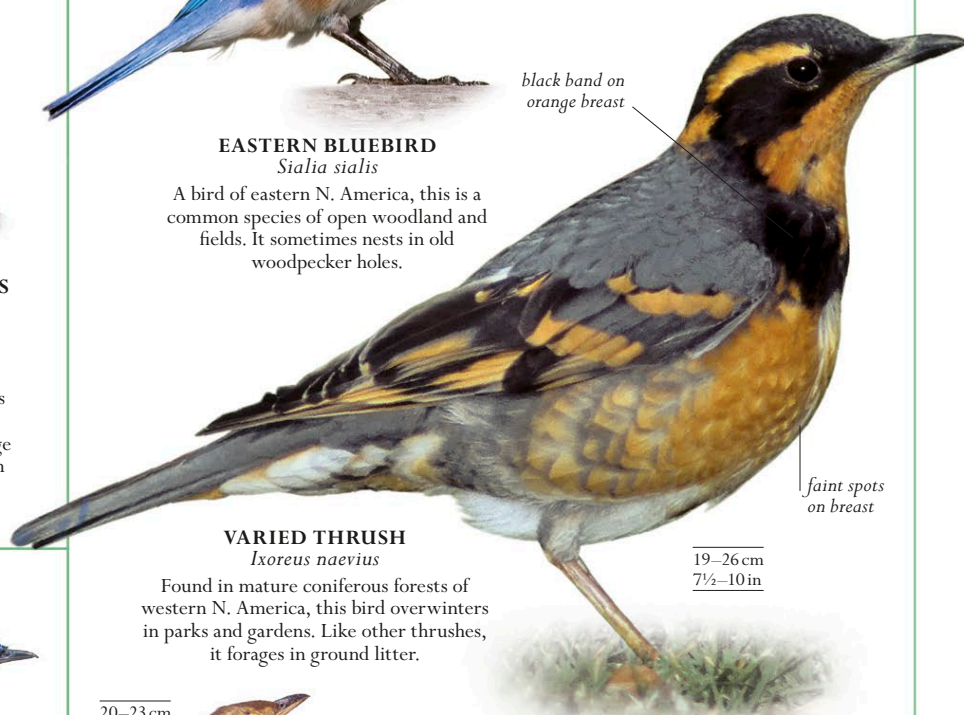
Belonging to the family Turdidae, most thrushes are woodland birds that forage on the ground for invertebrate prey, such as earthworms, snails, and insects. They are found worldwide, but the majority of species occur in the Old World. Many have melodious songs.

16–21 cm
6½–8½ in**EASTERN BLUEBIRD***Sialia sialis*

A bird of eastern N. America, this is a common species of open woodland and fields. It sometimes nests in old woodpecker holes.

22 cm
9 in**ORANGE-HEADED THRUSH***Zoothera citrina*

One of many tropical Old World *Zoothera* thrushes, this species is found in forests from the Himalayas to Bali, Indonesia.

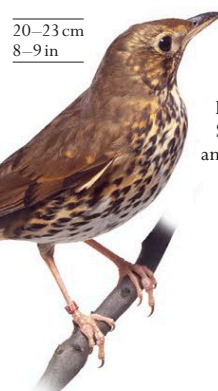


black band on orange breast

faint spots on breast

VARIED THRUSH*Ixoreus naevius*

Found in mature coniferous forests of western N. America, this bird overwinters in parks and gardens. Like other thrushes, it forages in ground litter.

19–26 cm
7½–10 in20–23 cm
8–9 in**SONG THRUSH***Turdus philomelos*

Found from Europe to Siberia, this woodland and garden bird habitually uses a hard surface as an "anvil" to smash open snail shells.

20–28 cm
8–11 in**AMERICAN ROBIN***Turdus migratorius*

Unrelated to the European robin, this N. American thrush sometimes gathers in winter roosts of up to quarter of a million birds.

24–29 cm
9½–11½ in**EURASIAN BLACKBIRD***Turdus merula*

A common long-tailed thrush of woodland habitats ranging from Europe and N. Africa to India, the highly territorial blackbird often visits gardens.

22–27 cm
9–10½ in**FIELDFARE***Turdus pilaris*

This bird breeds in N. Eurasia and winters further south, where it flocks together in fields.